



INTRODUCING · TFC CONNECT

Don't build alone. Find your people.

A co-founder matching portal and a startup directory in one. One account, one profile, seeded through TFC's 90+ campus chapters, and free for every founder.

● Co-founder Match

● Startup Directory

● Founder Fit Kit

● Collections

● Chapter verified

● DU

● NSUT

● IIT Madras BS

● DTU

● SRCC

● IIIT-D

● + 85 chapters

01

Concept & users

02

UX, design & screens

03

Functional specs

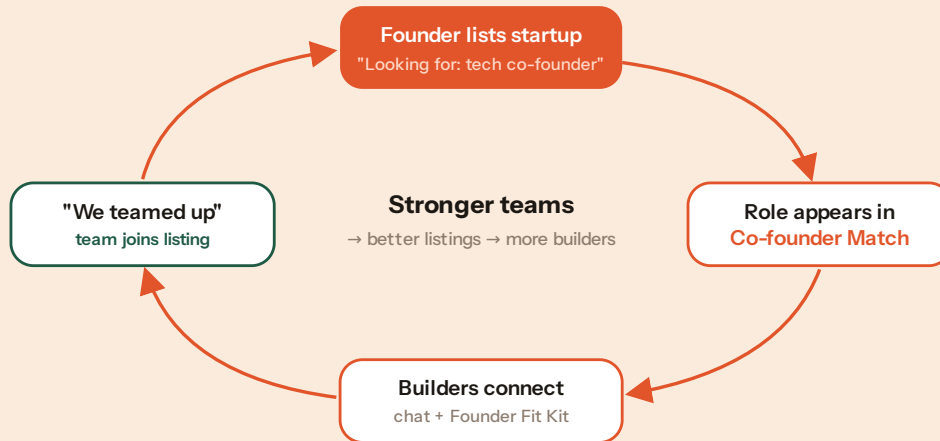
04

Tech, launch & roadmap

One product, two sides, one loop

TFC Connect is free for everyone. The goal is not revenue. It's **density and trust**: the more real founders are on it, the more useful it gets. It also becomes TFC's best source of serious founders for Launchpad and Startup School.

The flywheel



Positioning

"Where student and early-stage founders find their team and get seen."

India-first · campus-rooted · chapter-verified

Why TFC wins this

- **Built-in supply:** 90+ chapters and every Fellowship '26 applicant on day one
- **Trust layer:** college and chapter verification that generic platforms don't have
- **Next step built in:** matched teams go into Startup School and Launchpad
- **Not job-hunting:** it's about building, which fits TFC's goal of making startups the college norm

Principles

Free forever for founders

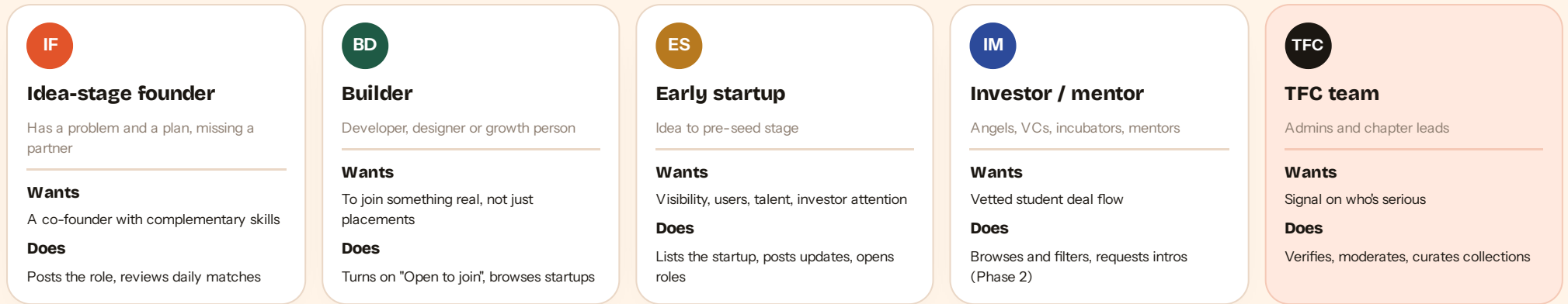
Verified over viral

Quality over volume

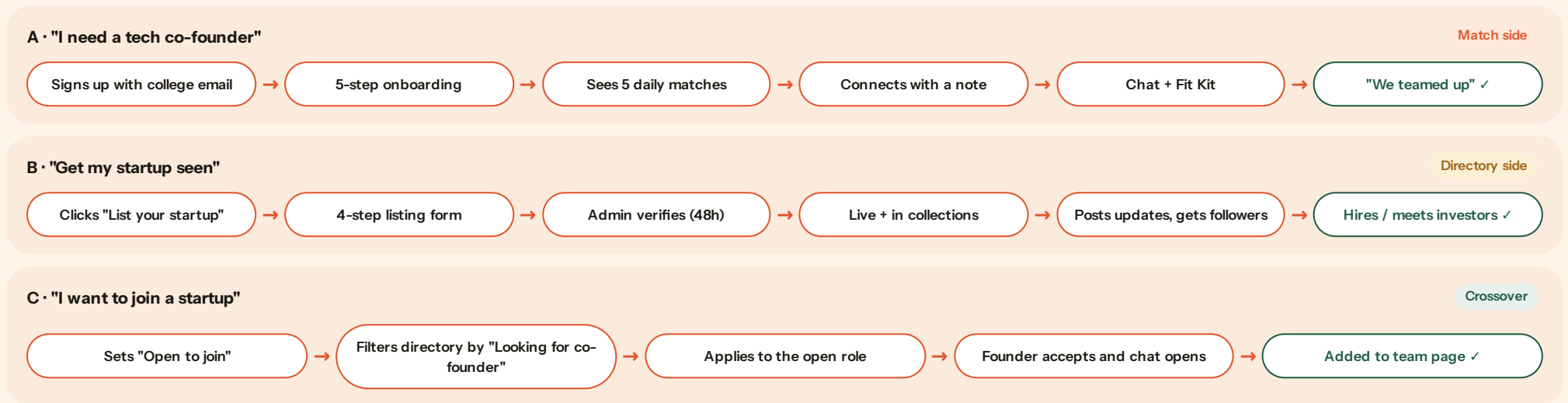
Mobile-first

Never a blank screen

Who it's for and what they come to do

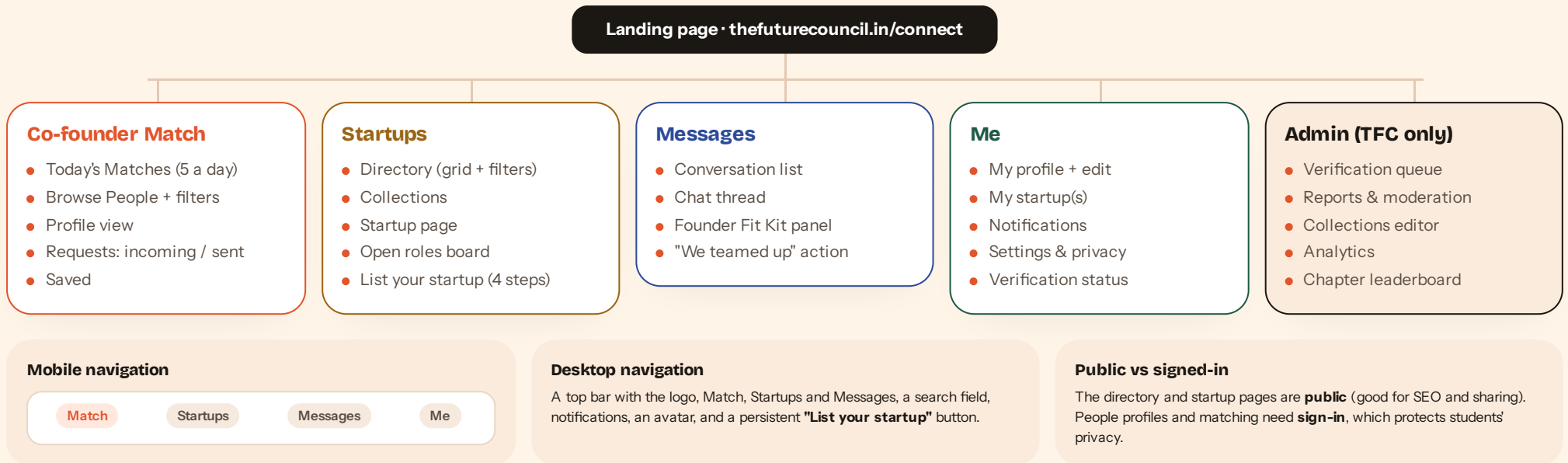


Key user journeys



Sitemap

One account and one navigation. On mobile, the four core areas sit in the bottom tab bar, and Admin appears only for TFC staff.



Look & feel: the Builder World from thefuturecouncil.in

TFC Connect lives inside the site's "Builder World", with its warm cream, night ink, TFC orange and forest green. It reuses the same fonts, pill buttons and recurring objects, so moving from the main site into the portal feels like one product.

Colour (from tfc-theme.css)



Orange #E2542A	Orange deep #AE3D18	Ink #1B1712	Warm #FFF4E8	Forest #1F5A45
Light Orange #FBE6D4	Light Orange deep #EAD7C6	Dark Ink #5A4E44	Dark Warm #2C4A9A	Light Forest #E8F1ED

Status chips (always the same meaning)



Typography

Don't queue. Build.

Bricolage Grotesque 800 · headlines, numbers

Instrument Sans for body, buttons and UI text.

Instrument Sans 400/500/600

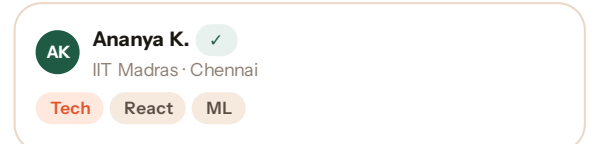
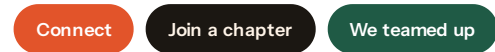
● LABELS, STAMPS, METADATA

IBM Plex Mono 500/600 · uppercase, tracked

Shape

Pill buttons and chips (999px) · 16–18px cards on white with a warm hairline · headlines at -2% tracking

Components



Borrowed object: the dashed path



Used for onboarding steps and the "Talk → Test → Team up" journey

Borrowed object: the night sky



Chapter colleges as glowing chips for social proof

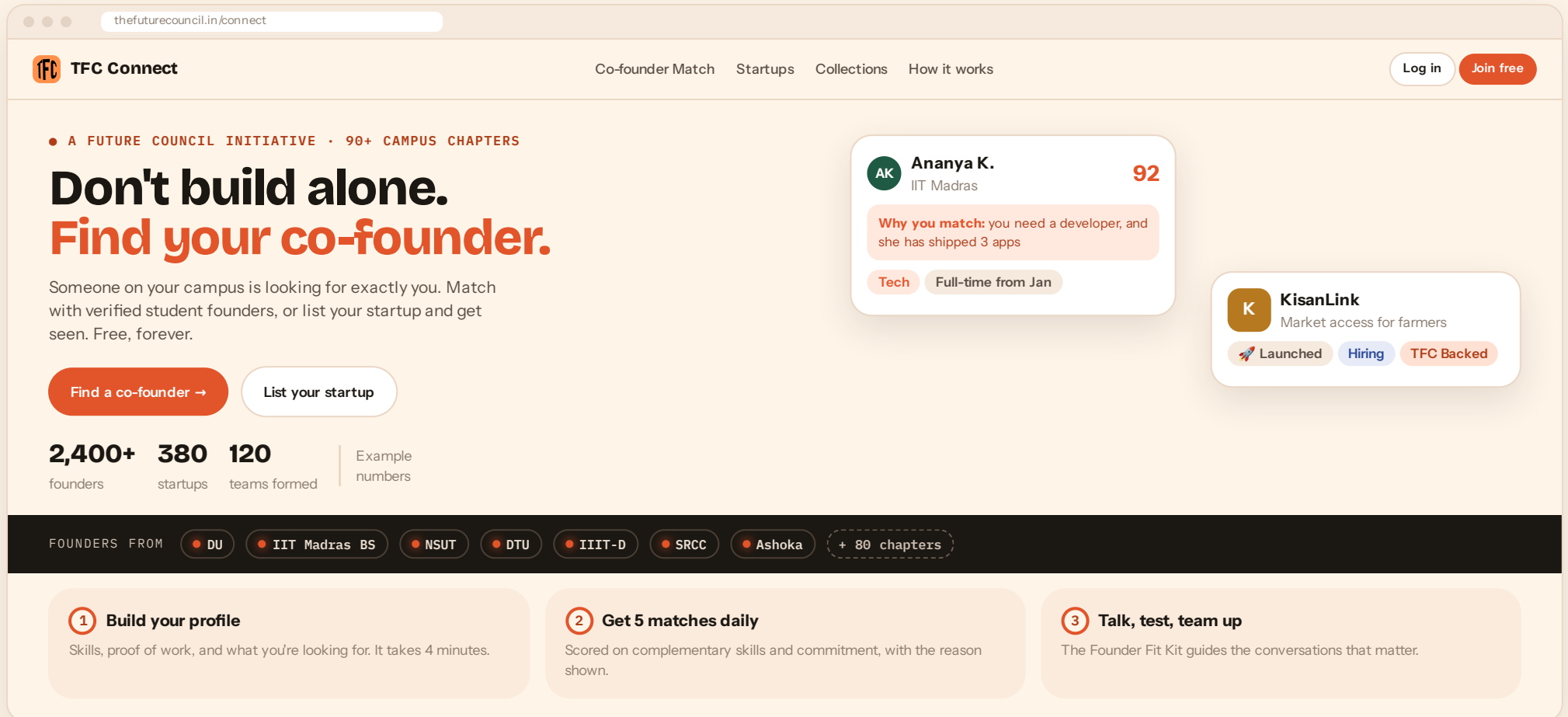
Tone of voice

It's the site's voice: short, punchy, student-to-student. "Don't build alone." "Someone on your campus is looking for you."

Empty states & access

Always show the next action. Contrast of at least 4.5:1 (use orange-deep for text on cream), 44px tap targets, and chips always carry text, never colour alone.

Landing page: two doors, one promise

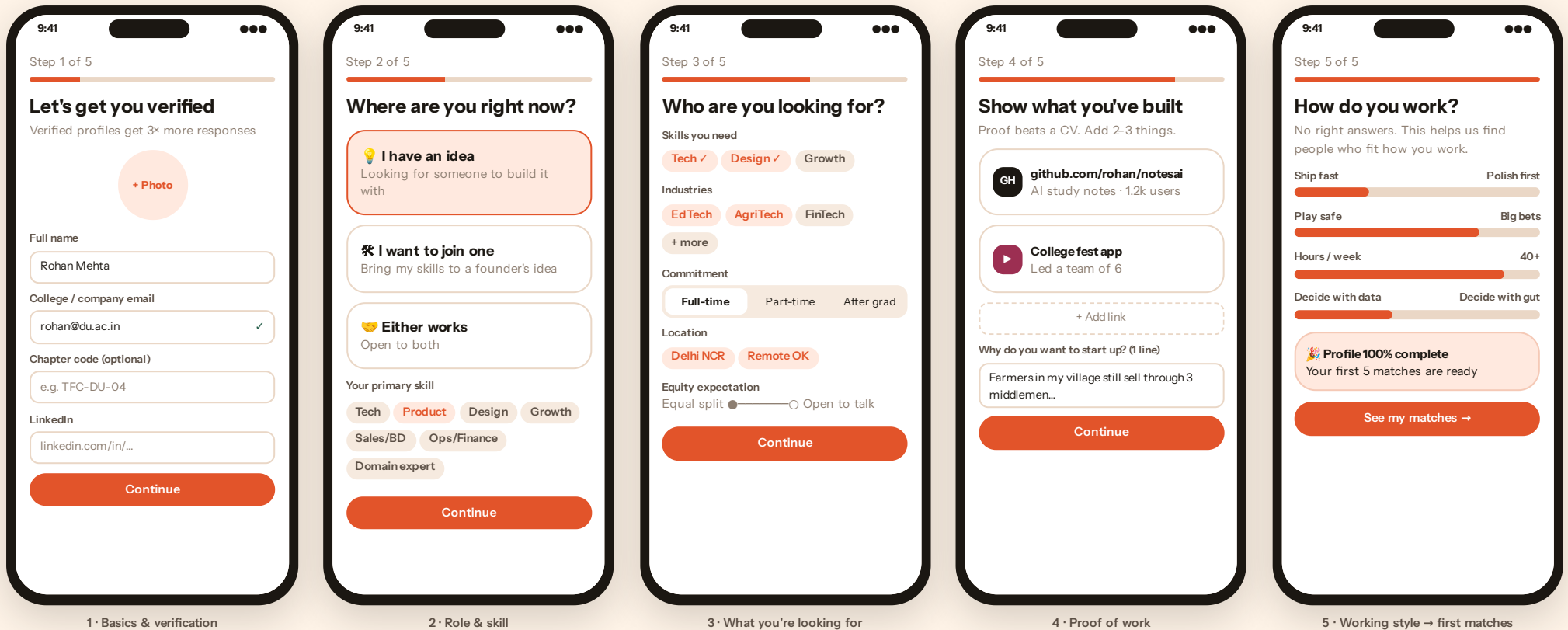


Hero: two equal CTAs, one for each side of the product. Live cards preview the product instead of a stock illustration.

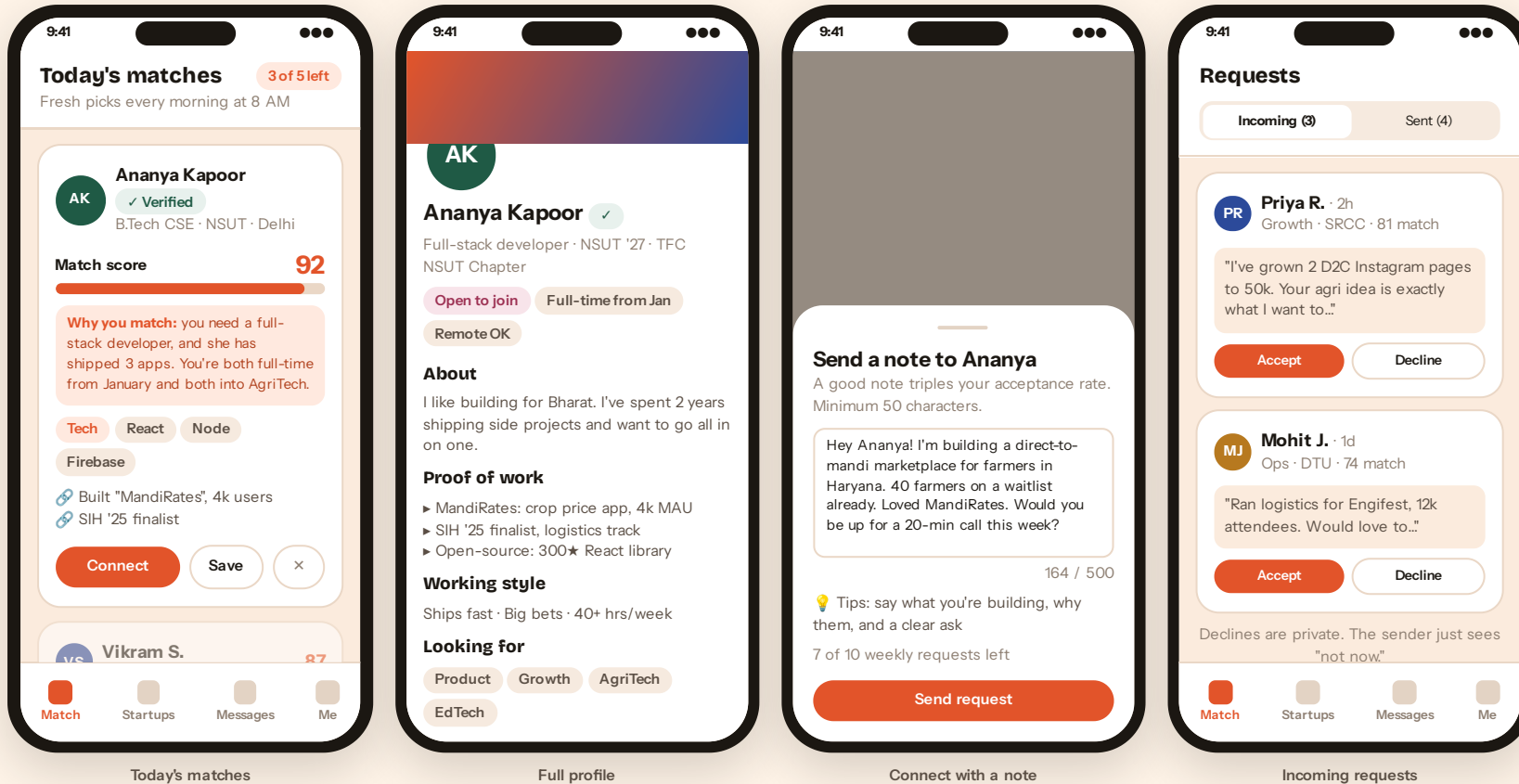
Social proof: real counters and chapter colleges. Students trust peers from known campuses.

Below the fold: featured startups this week, a "Teamed up on TFC" stories carousel, FAQ, and a footer CTA.

Onboarding: 5 steps, about 4 minutes, with a progress bar throughout



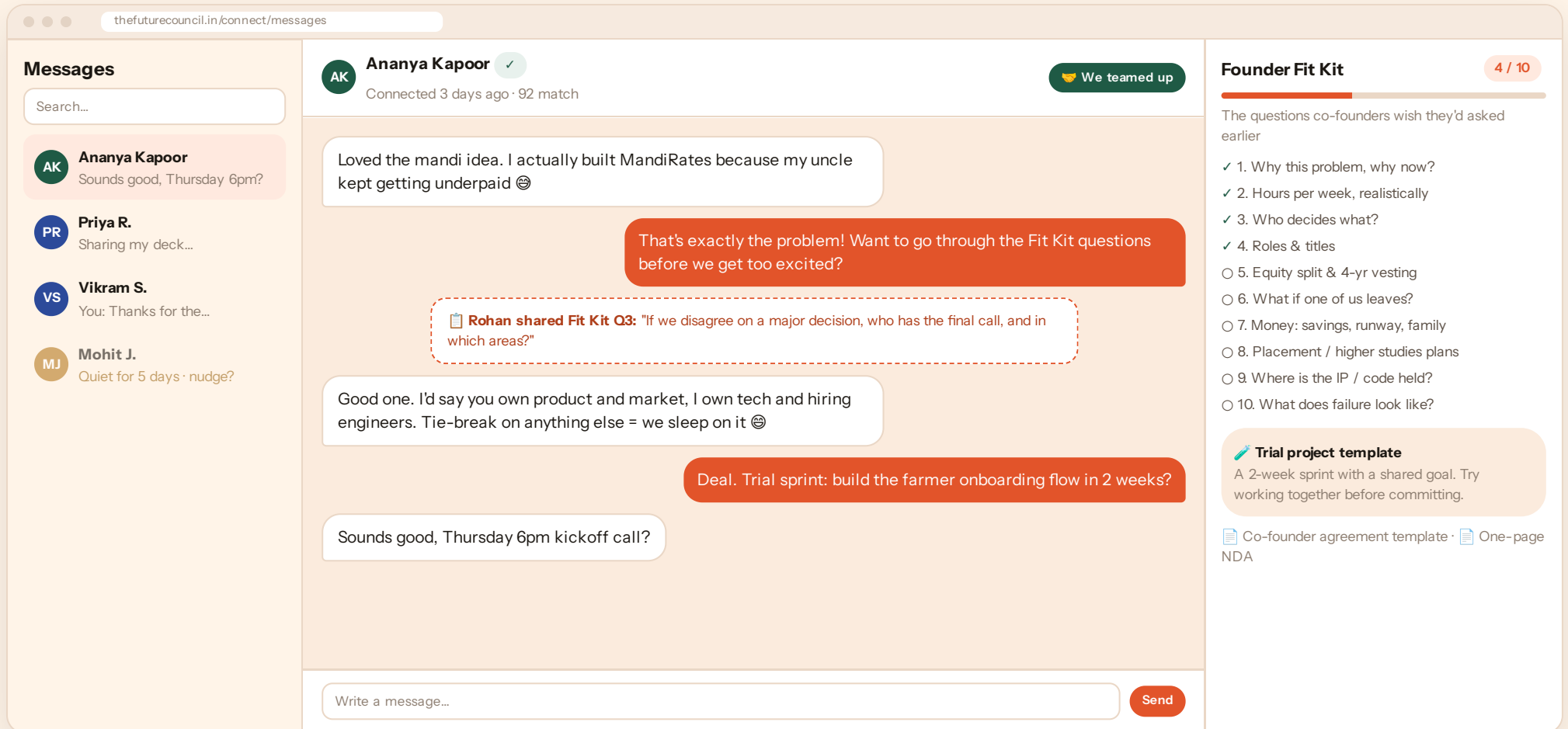
Daily matches, full profiles, and requests with intent



UX decisions

- **Cards, not swipes.** Swiping rewards looks. Cards reward substance.
- **5 a day.** Scarcity makes people actually read each profile.
- **"Why you match"** explains the score and gives an opening line.
- **Required note.** This kills spam and "hi" messages.
- **Private declines** reduce social anxiety.
- **Contact info hidden** until both people accept.

From "hello" to "we're a team": the conversation is guided



Fit Kit turns awkward topics into a checklist. Either person can "share" a question into the chat.

Nudges go out after 5 quiet days: "Still exploring with Mohit? Archive or pick it up."

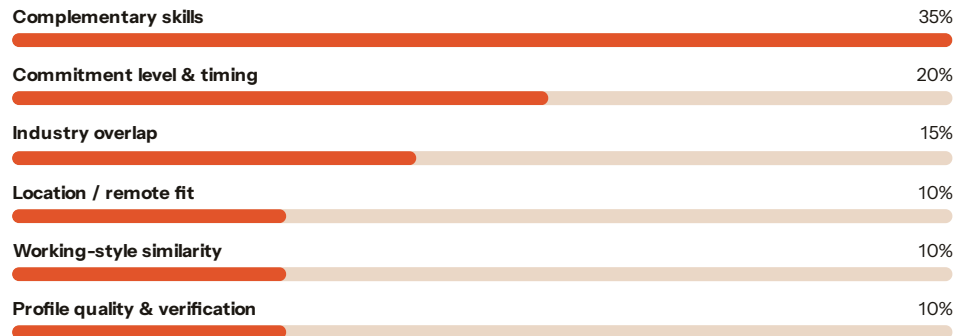
"We teamed up" needs both people to confirm. It creates a joint startup listing and counts toward the north-star metric.

Safety: report/block in the ... menu, links scanned for spam, and messages auto-flagged for admins on reports.

How matching works

For the MVP, use transparent rules, not black-box AI. That's easy to build, easy to explain in "Why you match," and good enough at this scale. It's computed nightly.

Match score (0–100)

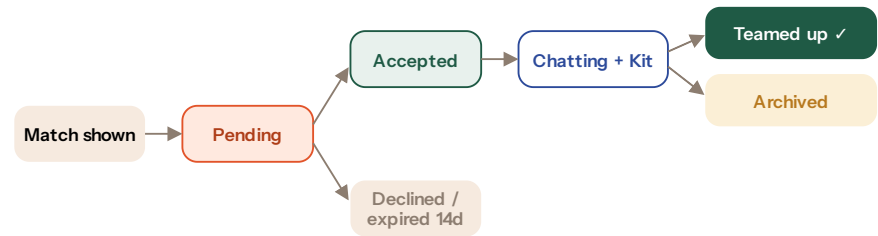


Skills are scored two ways: they have what you need and you have what they need. A one-sided match scores half.

Hard filters (excluded, never shown)

- Full-time seeker vs. "after graduation" person
- Both idea-holders with no interest in joining ("I have an idea" × "I have an idea")
- Blocked, already connected, or declined in the last 90 days
- Inactive for more than 30 days

Connection lifecycle



Rules & limits (these protect quality, not a paywall)

Daily matches	5 curated each morning, plus unlimited browse & search
Requests	10 per week (pending), note of at least 50 characters required
Expiry	Unanswered requests expire after 14 days
Freshness	"Still looking?" check every 30 days. Inactive profiles are hidden.
Verification	College email · chapter code · LinkedIn · TFC Fellow badge
Idea safety	"Share the problem, not the secret sauce," plus an NDA template

Directory: browse, filter, and follow India's campus startups

thefuturecouncil.in/connect/startups

TFC Connect

Match **Startups** Messages

Search startups...

+ List your startup

COLLECTION

Launchpad Fellows '26

20 startups

COLLECTION

Top campus startups: DU

34 startups

COLLECTION

Built for Bharat

41 startups

COLLECTION

AI by students

56 startups

Filters

128 startups · AgriTech · EdTech · Delhi NCR

Sort: **Trending** ▼

Stage

☒ Idea

☒ Building MVP

☒ Launched

☐ Revenue

☐ Funded

Industry

AgriTech

EdTech

FinTech

Health

Climate

Looking for

☒ Co-founder

☐ Interns

☐ Beta users

☐ Investors

City · College

Delhi NCR

☒ Verified only

K

KisanLink ✓

Sell crops direct to mandis

Launched

TFC Backed

Needs co-founder

AgriTech · Delhi

♥ 214

P

PrepPal ✓

AI mock interviews in Hindi

Revenue

Hiring

Raising

EdTech · Noida

♥ 189

G

GreenBin

Campus waste to compost

Building

Needs co-founder

Climate · DU

♥ 97

S

ShiftUp ✓

Part-time jobs for students

Launched

Hiring

HR · Gurugram

♥ 156

F

FeeFlow

UPI fee collection for coaching

Idea

Needs co-founder

FinTech · Delhi

♥ 44

M

MedMitra ✓

Pharmacy stock for Tier-3

Funded

TFC Backed

Health · Jaipur

♥ 302

Collections on top: TFC's editorial curation is the moat and gives people a reason to come back weekly.

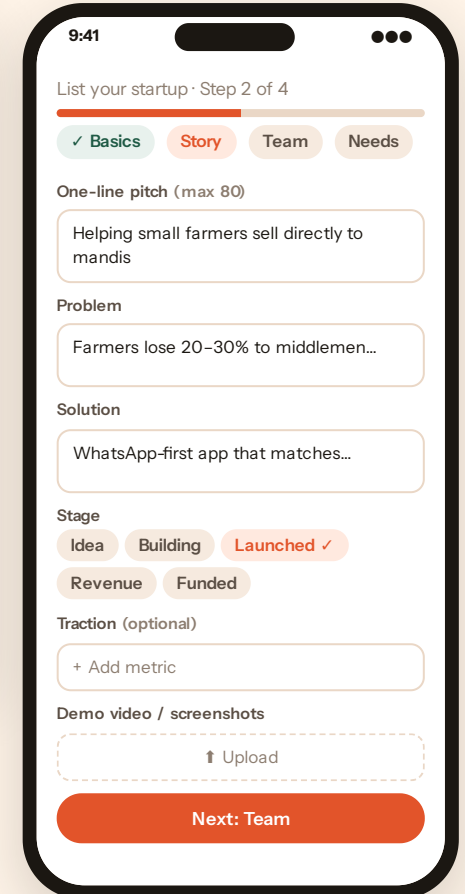
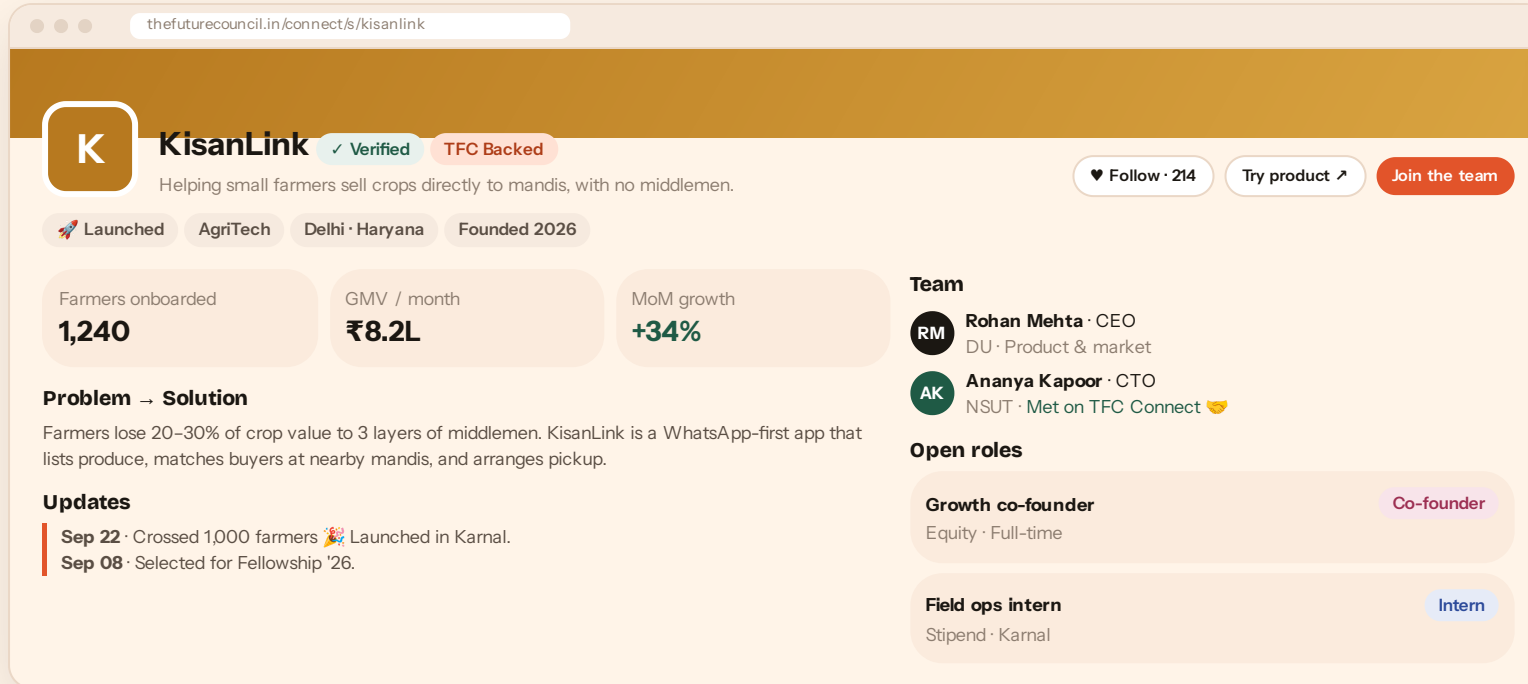
Status chips answer "can I get involved?" at a glance: needs co-founder, hiring, raising.

Public and shareable: every listing is SEO-indexed, which gives founders a real link to put in their bio.

TFC TFC CONNECT • PRODUCT PLAN

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Startup page (desktop) and "List your startup" (mobile)



4-step listing: Basics → Story → Team → Needs

Listings, verification, and keeping the directory alive

Listing fields

GROUP	FIELDS	STATUS
Basics	Name, logo, website/demo link, industry, city, founded year	Required
Story	One-liner (80 characters), problem, solution, stage	Required
Team	Members linked to profiles, with roles. Invite by email.	Required
Needs	Status tags: co-founder, hiring, beta users, raising, mentors	Required
Proof	Traction metrics, funding raised, screenshots, demo video	Optional
Private	Pitch deck, visible only to verified investors (Phase 2) and TFC	Optional
Roles	Open roles: title, type (co-founder/intern/freelance), skills, commitment	Optional

Verification tiers

Listed

How: anyone submits, and spam is filtered automatically
Gets: a basic public page

✓ Verified

How: verified founder email plus a working product link, with admin review within 48h
Gets: a badge and ranking boost

TFC Backed

How: Launchpad fellows or TFC team review
Gets: featured collections and top placement

Engagement features

- **Follow** a startup to see its updates in a personal feed
- **Upvote** to power the weekly trending ranking
- **Updates:** short founder posts (like a changelog), up to 3 a week
- **Apply to role:** uses your profile plus a note, and the founder accepts to open a chat
- **Share card:** an auto-generated Open Graph image for Instagram and LinkedIn

No graveyards

No update in 90 days gets an "inactive" label and moves down the ranking. The founder gets a reminder email at 60 days.

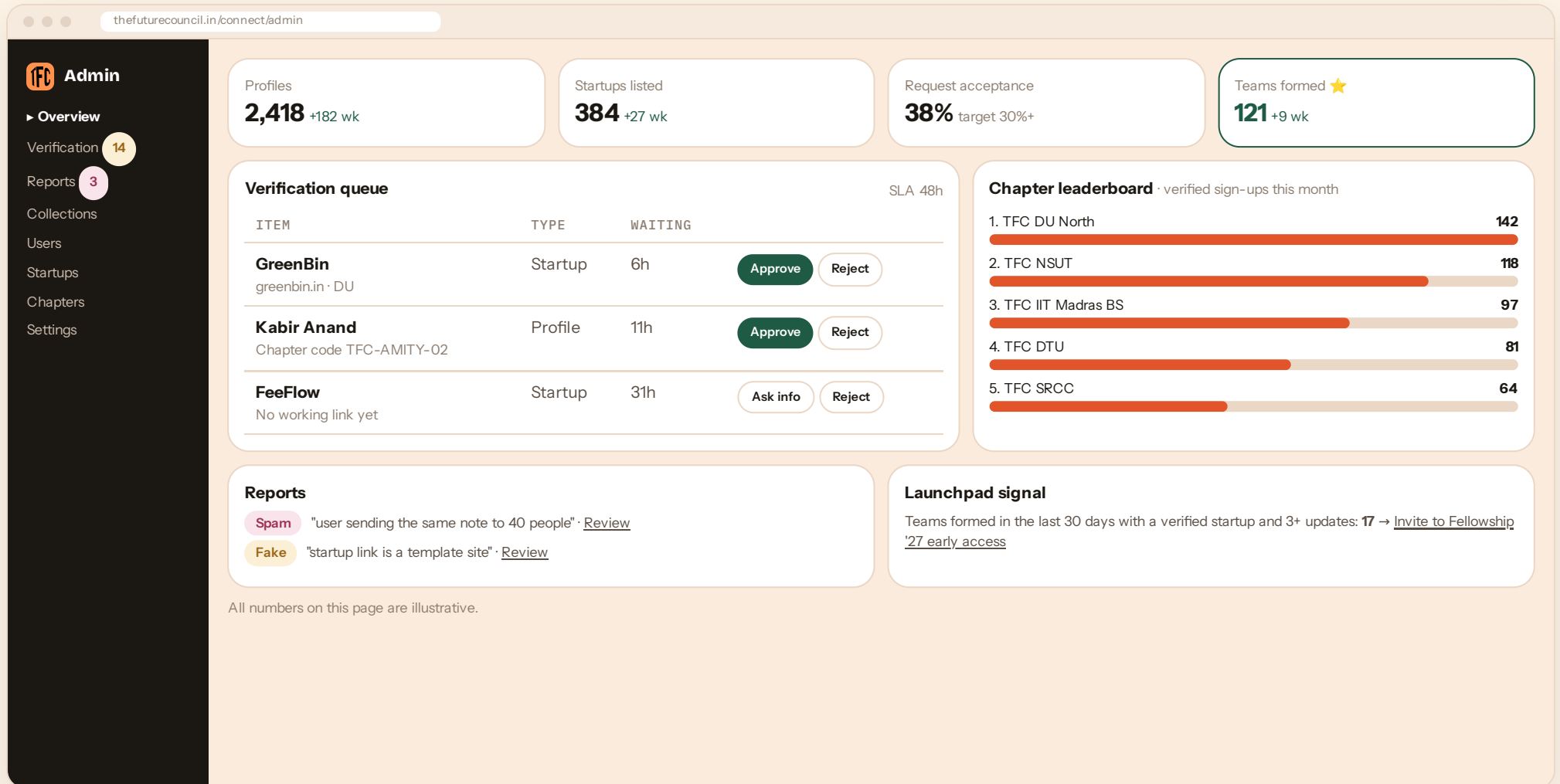
Trending formula

$(\text{Follows} + \text{upvotes} + \text{role applications in the last 7 days}) \times \text{a verification multiplier, with a recency decay applied.}$

Investor side (Phase 2)

Investors apply for an account. Deck access and intro requests are gated, and the founder always accepts or declines. It's free for both sides.

Admin: verify, moderate, curate, measure



Stack and data model

This stack is quick to build with a small team (it works well in Antigravity IDE) and nearly free to run on free tiers until you reach thousands of users.

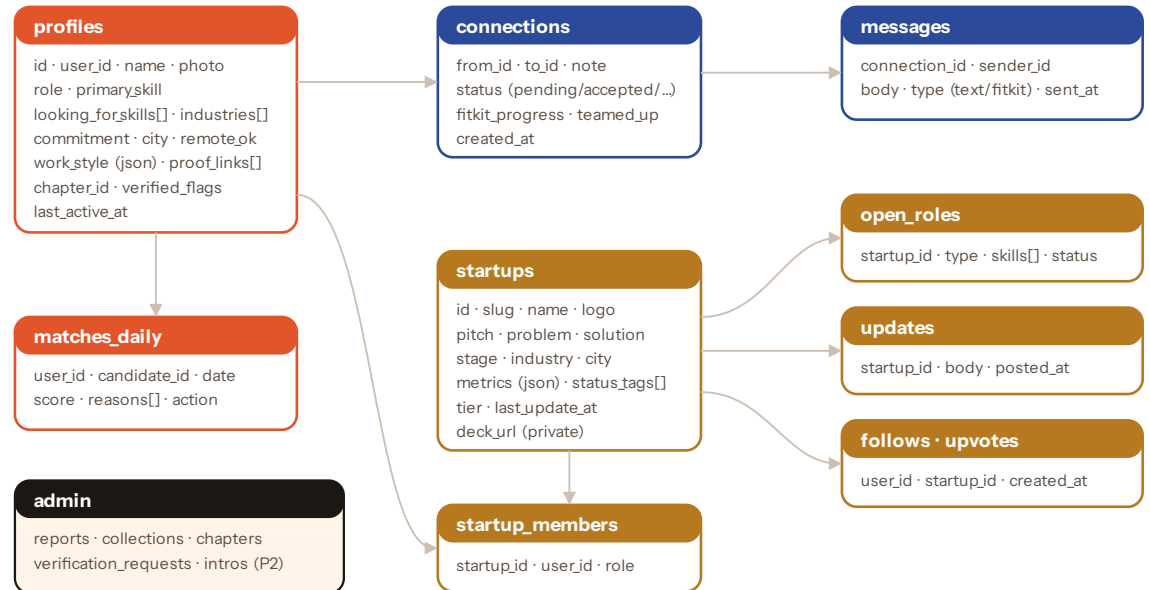
Stack

Frontend	Next.js + Tailwind + shadcn/ui, on Vercel
Backend	Supabase: Postgres, Auth, Storage, Row-Level Security
Chat	Supabase Realtime
Matching	Nightly Supabase cron / Edge Function, SQL scoring
Email	Resend: daily digest, nudges, verification
Search	Postgres full-text (MVP) → Typesense later
Analytics	PostHog: funnels, retention
WhatsApp	Optional: match alerts through the existing LetsBot setup

Privacy by default

Row-Level Security means people's contact info is only readable when a connection is accepted. Students can hide their profile from their own college. Delete account removes everything.

Core tables



Launch plan: beat the cold start, then measure what matters

Seeding the network

- 1 **Private beta: 300+ profiles before any announcement**
Invite every Fellowship '26 applicant (selected or not, since they're all founders), then the chapter leads. An empty matching app kills itself.
- 2 **Go city by city, not all of India at once**
Start with Delhi NCR (DU, NSUT, DTU, IIIT-D, SRCC) plus the IIT Madras BS community. Density in one region beats a thin spread.
- 3 **Pre-fill the directory**
The TFC team lists 50–100 known campus startups as "Unclaimed," and founders claim them. The directory never looks empty.
- 4 **Chapter Challenge**
Chapters compete on verified sign-ups. The winner gets a featured collection plus a TFC event.
- 5 **Content loop on Instagram**
A weekly "5 startups to watch" carousel pulled from the directory, plus "Teamed up on TFC" founder stories. It grows TFC's Instagram and brings in listings.
- 6 **Hack for builders**
Idea people will outnumber developers. Run co-founder mixers at hackathons and tech chapters, and highlight "builders" in the UI.

NORTH-STAR METRIC

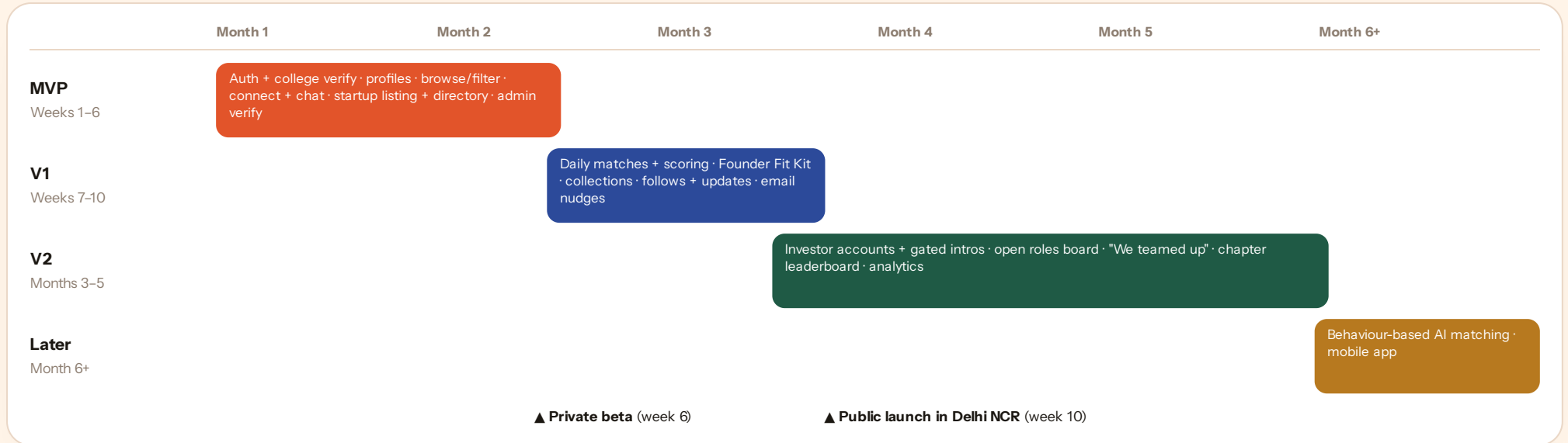
Teams formed per month

Both people tap "We teamed up." That's the clearest proof the product works and the best story for TFC.

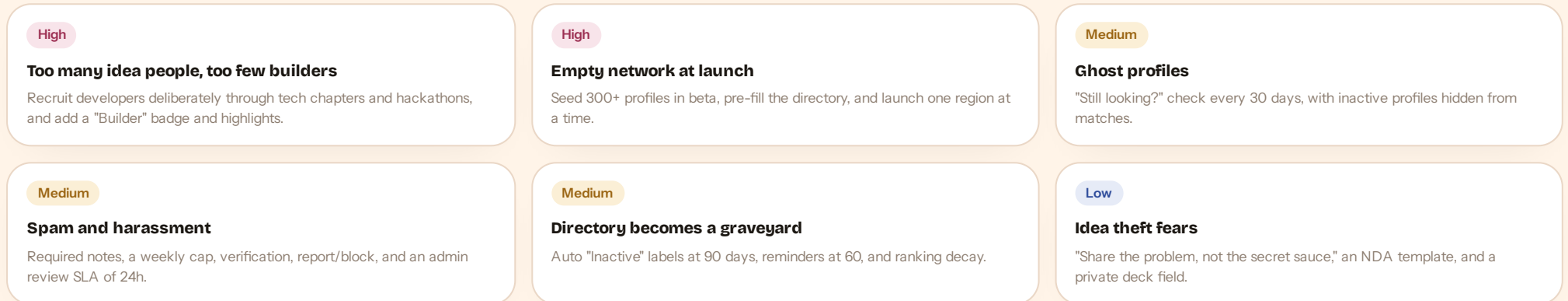
Health metrics

METRIC	HEALTHY TARGET
Profile completion	≥ 70% finish all 5 steps
Request acceptance	≥ 30%
Real conversations	≥ 40% of chats pass 5 messages
Weekly active	≥ 35% of profiles
Listings verified	≥ 60% within 48h
Active listings	≥ 50% updated in the last 90 days
TFC funnel	Share of users who join Startup School or apply to Launchpad

Roadmap and risks



Risks we're designing around



Next steps this week: ① Lock the name → ② Build clickable prototypes of the 8 core screens → ③ Test them with 10 founders from chapters → ④ Start MVP sprint 1 (auth + profiles)